

01 SMALL TALK

When you feel really tired of work, do you want a long rest or a change of scene?

Have you ever tried learning a new language as an adult? Was it fun or stressful?

Do you save money for a big goal, or spend it as you go?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

- ① ~~"My hobby is watching Netflix."~~
✓ **"I'm really into Netflix these days."**
원어만은 'My hobby is ~'를 거의 안 써요. 'I'm into ~' / 'I love ~ing'이 훨씬 자연스러워요.
- ② ~~"I have a lot of stress."~~
✓ **"I'm really stressed out."**
'stress'는 보통 형용사(stressed)나 'under stress'로 써요. 'have stress'는 콩글리시예요.
- ③ ~~"I want to healing this weekend."~~
✓ **"I want to relax and recharge this weekend."**
'healing'은 한국식 표현이에요. 쉬고 싶을 땐 relax, recharge, unwind를 써요.

03 오늘의 워업

각 질문에 A 또는 B 손가락으로 표시. 마음에 드는 거 하나만 짧게 이유.

WARM-UP

Quick Choice (5분)

- 1 Quit first and then study abroad (A) or keep your job and study later (B)?
- 2 Study abroad to change your career (A) or to take a real break (B)?
- 3 Spend your savings on one year abroad (A) or save the money for now (B)?
- 4 A new skill matters most (A) or a new network of people matters most (B)?

Study Abroad After Quitting — Career Reset or Risky Gap?

BACKGROUND

퇴사 후 유학은 멋진 커리어 리셋처럼 보이지만, 현실적으로는 돈·공백·언어·불안이 한꺼번에 따라오는 선택이에요. 새로운 나라에서 공부하면 방향을 바꿀 기회가 생기지만, 월급이 끊긴 상태로 1년을 버티는 부담도 작지 않죠. 중요한 건 유학 자체가 아니라 그 시간이 어떤 기술·경험·네트워크로 이어지는지예요. 쉬고 싶은 마음과 다시 시작하고 싶은 마음을 구분하는 것도 필요해요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Quitting a job to study abroad can be a powerful reset, but it is not automatically a career solution. A new country, language program, or network can open a different future. At the same time, losing income for a year or more can create real pressure. The choice becomes serious when someone thinks about savings, visa rules, living costs, and what skill they will bring back. Some people need a clean break to grow. Others may be running away from burnout without a clear next step. Studying abroad also looks like travel from the outside, because it changes language, country, and routine all at once. The real value depends on whether the time creates a clearer direction, not only distance from the old job.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

a fresh start — 새 출발

burned out — 번아웃된, 진이 빠진

a safety net — 안전망

a clean break — 깔끔한 단절

step out of your comfort zone — 편한 영역에서 벗어나다

a wake-up call — 정신 번쩍 드는 계기

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, I'd prepare everything first — quitting with no plan feels too risky for me.

It depends on my savings, but usually I'd keep working until the new thing is ready.

I'd say a gap is okay if I can show what I actually learned during that time.

What helps me feel okay is having a clear story, like a new skill or a certificate.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'study at home in Korea' or a 'pack up and study abroad' person?
- 2 When was the last time you learned something in another language — a recipe, a song, or even a YouTube video?
- 3 Quick — if you got one fully-paid year abroad to study: a big English-speaking city, a quiet small town, or somewhere totally new and far?
- 4 Picture this: a friend just quit their job to study abroad for a year. What's the first thing you'd ask them?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Would you quit your job first, or prepare everything while still working? Why?

Honestly, I'd prepare everything first — quitting with no plan feels too risky for me.

It depends on my savings, but usually I'd keep working until the new thing is ready.

Q2. What would make a one-year work gap feel okay — to you, and to a future boss?

I'd say a gap is okay if I can show what I actually learned during that time.

What helps me feel okay is having a clear story, like a new skill or a certificate.

Q3. How much money would you want saved before making this kind of choice?

It really comes down to how many months I can live without any income.

In my case, I'd want at least one year of living costs saved before any big move.

Q4. How would you know it's real growth, and not just burnout?

The way I see it, real growth feels like moving toward something, not running away.

When I think about it, the difference is energy — burnout drains me, but growth excites me.

Q5. Can a reset still help even if your next step is unclear?

Most of the time, a reset still helps because I need space before things get clear.

Looking back, a break taught me that the answer usually comes after rest, not before.